



May 23, 2017 Delaware County Council Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=R78OUzpMisM
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:00:04](#) The meeting of the Delaware County Council was called to order by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Council members Lander, Chambers, Lassiter, Cratchit, Piper, Alexander, and Bledsoe (Note: exact name spellings transcribed phonetically from roll call: Blender/Lander, Chambers, Lassiter, Cratchit, Piper, Alexander, Bledsoe).
 - **Presiding Officer:** President/Chair identified in discussion as Mr. Wachtel-Busch (transcribed as "Waco Bush").

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** [00:00:26](#) The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Approval of Minutes:** [00:01:22](#) A motion was made and seconded to approve the minutes of the April 25th meeting. Passed by Voice Vote / Roll Call [00:01:35](#).
 - *Note on Correction:* Council member Cratchit pointed out an omission regarding a discussion of the DROP (Deferred Retirement Option Plan) program that was removed from the prior agenda without notice; the presiding officer offered an apology.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Financial Agenda & Transfers

- **00:02:42 Coroner<U+2019>s Office Appropriation Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Irene Hyatt, Secretary in the Coroner<U+2019>s Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The office requested \$300,000 for autopsy, lab, and x-ray expenses due to an unexpectedly high volume of cases early in the year. Council discussed funding sources (County General, Rainy Day, Public Safety funds) and whether the full amount was needed immediately. Staff noted historical spending patterns.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Amended to appropriate **\$50,000** to get through the immediate period. Approved by Roll Call Vote **00:13:46**.
- **00:14:21 Health Insurance Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$4,250 to correct a bookkeeping error regarding health insurance appropriations from the previous November.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote **00:15:09**.
- **00:15:23 GIS Grant Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Representing Kyle Johnson, Plan Commission.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$2,600 from a grant to buy equipment for field data collection for GIS before the end-of-year deadline.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote **00:16:10**.
- **00:16:45 911 / Communications Center Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Emily Anderson, Coroner Administrator / Department heads.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfers involving line items for life insurance, short-term/long-term disability, and office machines to cover rising short-term disability costs and policy changes moving from self-insured to premium-based insurance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote **00:18:59**.
- **00:19:13 Highway Department Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Department leadership.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments between mechanic and equipment operator line items.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote **00:19:52**.
- **00:20:03 Commissioners' Maintenance Transfer (First Addendum)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$24,569 for part-time maintenance personnel line items.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote **00:20:48**.
- **00:21:01 Highway Department Truck Driver / Equipment Operator Transfers**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Department.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocations within salary and line items to prevent residual budget shortages.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:21:38](#).
- [00:22:06](#) **Communications Center New Hire Transfer (Second Addendum)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Director of Homeland Security / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$19,125 to cover a staffing transition with an effective date of June 3rd to accommodate payout of a departing employee while onboarding a new hire, avoiding overtime costs. Minor discrepancies (\$66 short/over) were addressed, with assurances no general fund tapping would occur.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:27:47](#).
- [00:28:06](#) **Omnibus Financial Agenda Approval**
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve all financial agenda transfers with line-item reductions and salary amendments. Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:29:05](#).

Departmental Updates & Special Discussions

- [00:29:32](#) **Purdue Extension Program Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Molly Constant, Health and Human Sciences Educator for Purdue Extension (accompanied by intern Audrey Milligan).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Provided an annual programmatic update highlighting responses to the opioid epidemic (partnering with Meridian Health Services on maternal health/felony diversion programs, life skills, parenting, and cooking classes), kinship care training for DCS foster/kinship parents, and chronic disease/diabetes education addressing Delaware County's health rankings (87th out of 92 in Indiana).
- [00:36:11](#) **Needle Distribution Resolution Discussion**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Council discussed a proposed joint resolution regarding needle distribution. Because of mixed feedback and lack of immediate support/forum readiness from the Commissioners, the item was removed from the official agenda for digestion and potential future reintroduction.
- [00:39:14](#) **County Police Retirement Plan / DROP (Deferred Retirement Option Plan) Work Session**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Hughes (Attorney), Dan Brown (Actuarial Services, OneAmerica/McCready and Keen), and local officials.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** In-depth deliberation regarding a proposed amendment to the Delaware County Police Retirement Plan to establish a **3-year DROP (Deferred Retirement Option Plan)** program for merit deputies.
 - Actuary Dan Brown confirmed DROP is designed to be actuarially neutral and will not immediately impact county funding requirements, though savings from replacing higher-paid deputies materialize over a generation.

- Extensive discussion occurred regarding pension funding history (historically underfunded in past decades, currently at roughly 63.9% funded status), how DROP handles benefit freezes, interest calculations, and health insurance provisions.
- Council discussed adding a **4-year sunset provision** to evaluate the DROP program's effectiveness and fiscal impact.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** [124:48] Motion made and seconded to instruct the attorney and actuary to incorporate a 4-year sunset provision into the DROP plan amendment and submit it to the police board, sheriff, and mayor. Approved by Roll Call Vote [125:41].

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No formal general public comment period with distinct external citizen speakers was recorded during this portion of the transcript; discussions remained among council members, staff, department heads, and invited presenters such as Irene Hyatt and Dan Brown.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **01:31:13** Council President announced a change in council liaison to the sheriff: shifting from himself to **Scott Alexander**.
 - **01:31:52** Discussion regarding upcoming state association conferences for council members, hotel reservations, and utilizing county travel arrangements.
- **Adjournment:** **01:34:29** The meeting concluded following final remarks on conference registrations and administrative travel logistics.

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